



GDD 69

Be the Safe Adult

The one they can tell, who notices, and responds right.

The safeguarding node that closes the Parent Layer, and the one that makes the entire kids' journey work, because from My Body, My Rules (g02) onward the curriculum tells children to tell a trusted adult, and this makes sure that adult exists, notices and responds right. It builds parents' safeguarding literacy: being tellable, spotting signs, knowing the known-adult risk, the POCSO basics, online safety, and above all responding the right way if a child discloses. Maximum-care, trauma-informed, never graphic. Seven mechanics, 29 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Be the one they can tell.

Be the Safe Adult is the safeguarding node of the Parent Layer, and the one that makes the entire kids' journey work, because that journey assumes a trusted adult behind the child. It builds parents' safeguarding literacy: being tellable, spotting signs of abuse and online exploitation, understanding the known-adult risk and the POCSO basics, keeping kids safer online and off, and, most importantly, responding the right way if a child discloses. It is maximum-care and trauma-informed, direct but never fear-mongering and never graphic, centres the child as always the protected victim, is educational and not legal advice, and routes real concerns immediately to the authorities. New v2 build, the keystone that closes the loop.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g69 · be-the-safe-adult (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / layer	Chapter 8 · Parent Layer · adult / warm / maximum-care
Thread / topics	B · Parent Layer · Safeguarding · UNESCO 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 5.5
Prerequisite / builds on	g68 · builds on g08 (Safety Squad), g02 (My Body, My Rules), g40 (Firewall)
Gating	Open · child-first; report-routed; not legal advice
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the be-the-safe-adult game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

16

myth-flips

29

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

The biggest protection is a child who knows they can tell you anything. Harm can reach any child, children often stay silent from fear, and most abuse is by someone known and trusted, not a stranger, so the safe adult is built on purpose: a calm, no-blame, tellable door. If a child discloses, the response shapes everything, believe them, stay calm rather than show horror, tell them clearly it is not their fault, don't interrogate, then act and protect, never hush it up. Under POCSO the child is always the victim and reporting is obliged: Childline 1098, the police and POCSO e-Box, cybercrime 1930 online.

Open door, no blame, POCSO-aware.

From the Chapter 8 personas (parenthood). Parents who just want their children safe, steady and able to tell them anything, the persona note: teach safe-adult parenting, an open door, no blame, the known-adult risk, POCSO-aware. This is the node that equips exactly that.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Kamla (protect the kids)	To be tellable and respond right if it ever happens.	strike-rewrite + role-play : be tellable, disclosure.
Any parent	To know the signs and the known-adult risk, calmly.	sort + match : spot the signs.
Vikram (online)	To handle online danger and reporting.	branch + role-play : safe online & off.
Divya & Priya	The law, the routes, and what to do.	match + sort : the law & the call.

Why this works (the evidence). A child's safety rests above all on a trusted adult they can tell, and children often stay silent from fear, threats or shame, so being warmly and deliberately tellable, the very 'tell a trusted adult' the whole curriculum relies on, is the biggest protection. Most abuse is by someone known and trusted (around nine in ten cases), and abusers often seem respectable, so calm vigilance and respecting a child's discomfort matter. The disclosure response shapes the child's safety and recovery, believe, stay calm, don't blame or interrogate, then act, and under India's POCSO Act any sexual offence against an under-18 is a crime, the child is always the victim, and reporting is obliged, via Childline 1098, the police, POCSO e-Box and cybercrime 1930.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the words.

It's a safeguarding game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (busting the denial-and-blame myths) with **role-play** giving the exact words for the disclosure response and the tellable door, and **branch** for the protect-and-report choices; **sort** and **match** map signs and routes. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE PARENT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a denial-or-blame myth.	Conceptual change.	16
role-play (voice) signature	Says the believing, calm, no-blame words.	Voice; the safe adult.	15
branch (the choice)	Chooses to believe, protect and report.	Judgement.	14
sort	Sorts sign vs ordinary; right vs wrong action; helps vs harms.	The line.	13
match	Pairs a red flag to attention; a route to its use; a step to its effect.	Connections.	10
reflect	Internalises tellability and child-first.	Values.	8
spot	Spots the tellable parent, the calm vigilance, the right priority.	Reading it.	8

29 of 84 moments are role-play or branch. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is sober resolve and quiet confidence, the steadiness of knowing exactly how to be the adult a child can turn to, the relief of the right words ready for the hardest moment, and the clarity of knowing the law and the call. The "I can be the one who notices and responds right" conviction lands deeply. Sam is a warm, steady guide; the tone is maximum-care, direct but never fear-mongering, never graphic, and always centred on the child as the protected victim.

Is it teaching?

Yes: being the trusted adult a child can tell; recognising signs of abuse and online exploitation and the known-adult risk; understanding POCSO basics and that the child is always the victim; responding to a disclosure correctly (believe, stay calm, don't blame or interrogate, reassure, act); and keeping a child safer online and off, with concerns routed to the authorities.

The belief it moves. From "it won't happen to us; they'd tell me anyway; danger is strangers; a respectable adult is safe; question whether they made it up; show your horror; the child must have allowed it; keep it private" → "harm can reach any child; tellability is built; most harm is by someone known; respectability isn't safety; believe them; stay calm; the child is never at fault; and reporting protects."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the be-tellable → spot-the-signs → if-they-tell-you → the-law-and-the-call → safe-online-and-off → tools arc, India-grounded, maximum-care and warm. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Be tellable	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, sort	A child who can tell you anything; the no-blame door.
Spot the signs	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Signs, grooming flags; most harm is by someone known.
If they tell you	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, sort	Believe, stay calm, no blame, no interrogating, act.
The law & the call	14	strike-rewrite, sort, branch	POCSO basics; child = victim; who to contact.
Safe online & off	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Real online risks; stay close; keep evidence; report.
Tools & respond	14	branch, role-play, match	Signs checklist, response steps, helpline card.

The 'believe them' flip + the 'never the child's fault' flip, verbatim.

flip: "If my child tells me, I should question whether they're making it up."
 UN -> "Question whether they're making it up."
 RE -> "Believe your child; children very rarely lie about abuse, and being believed is vital to their safety and recovery."

flip: "A child who was harmed must have done something to cause or allow it."
 UN -> "The child must have done something to cause or allow it."
 RE -> "A child is never to blame for abuse; the responsibility is entirely the abuser's, and the child needs to hear that clearly."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 69 Be the Safe Adult — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
It won't happen to my child.	Harm can reach any child; preparation protects.	It can happen.
My child would obviously tell me right away.	Children often stay silent; tellability is built on purpose.	Tellability is built.
Danger comes mainly from strangers.	Most abuse is by someone known and trusted.	Known, not stranger.
A respectable adult could never be a risk.	Abusers often seem respectable and use trust to gain access.	Respectability isn't safety.
Question whether they're making it up.	Believe them; children very rarely lie about abuse.	Believe them.
Showing horror or rage is the natural reaction.	Stay calm; visible horror can make a child shut down or feel blamed.	Stay calm.
A harmed child must have caused or allowed it.	A child is never to blame; the fault is entirely the abuser's.	Never the child's fault.
This is private; don't involve the authorities.	Abuse is a crime; reporting is obliged and protects the child.	Reporting protects.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** A real moment, a small disclosure to welcome, a worrying change, a child finding the words, a concern to act on.
2. **Voice or choose.** The parent finds the believing, calm, no-blame words (role-play), or chooses to protect and report (branch).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a denial-or-blame myth; RE writes the child-first truth.
4. **Believe & act.** Assure, believe, stay calm, let the child talk, then act and protect.
5. **The law & the call.** POCSO basics and the routes, Childline 1098, police, POCSO e-Box, cybercrime 1930.
6. **Sticker.** The Be the Safe Adult badge; GameDone records once. The Parent Layer, and the loop, complete.

Signature surface: the **tellable door** and the **disclosure response**. It carries Safety Squad (g08), My Body, My Rules (g02) and Firewall (g40) into adult safeguarding, closes the Parent Layer, and underwrites the entire kids' journey, from My Body, My Rules (g02) onward, the curriculum tells children to tell a trusted adult, and this makes sure that adult exists, notices and responds right.

Child-first; believe; report; never graphic.

- **The child is always the victim.** The child is never to blame, and the node centres their safety, dignity and recovery throughout.
- **The right disclosure response.** Believe, stay calm, don't blame or interrogate, reassure it's not their fault, let the child talk at their pace, then act, and never promise total secrecy or hush it up.
- **Known-adult risk, calmly.** Most abuse is by someone known; the node teaches calm vigilance and respecting a child's discomfort, not paranoia.
- **POCSO & the routes.** Any sexual offence against an under-18 is a crime and reporting is obliged: Childline 1098, the police, POCSO e-Box, and cybercrime 1930 for online abuse.
- **Direct, never fear-mongering, never graphic.** It gives no detail that could enable harm, is trauma-informed, and is educational, not legal advice, routing real concerns to the authorities.
- **Privacy & review.** Private by design (DPDP-aligned), on-device; expert-reviewed for child-protection.

If a child tells you, or you have a concern (India). Believe them, stay calm, and say clearly: "I believe you, it's not your fault, I'm glad you told me, I'll keep you safe." Don't interrogate, don't promise to tell no one, and act. The child is always the victim. Report and get help: Childline **1098**, the police or the POCSO e-Box, and cybercrime **1930** for online abuse. If a child is in immediate danger, emergency **112**. This is educational, not legal advice; real concerns go to the authorities.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. be-the-safe-adult** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** denial-myth flip and the **role-play** disclosure-response co-lead.
- **Maximum-care is a hard requirement.** Child-always-the-victim, believe-and-don't-interrogate, known-adult-risk, report-routing, never-graphic and not-legal-advice are contractual; expert-reviewed for child protection.
- **Fact-checked content.** Disclosure-response best practice, the most-abuse-is-by-known-persons evidence, and POCSO basics and report routes (1098, POCSO e-Box, 1930) verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 19%, 0% binary, 29 autonomy, 16 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** All concerns route via the shared safeguarding component (Childline 1098 / POCSO e-Box / police / cybercrime 1930 / emergency 112).
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g69 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): the child is always the protected victim; believe, stay calm, no blame, no interrogating, then act; known-adult risk without paranoia; report-routed; never graphic; educational, not legal advice; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **A tellable adult is the biggest protection, so build it.** Because children stay silent from fear and the safe adult is what the whole curriculum's 'tell a trusted adult' relies on, equipping that adult is the keystone of child protection.
- **Most harm is by someone known, so teach calm vigilance.** Since around nine in ten cases involve a known, trusted person, replacing stranger-danger with calm vigilance and respecting a child's discomfort genuinely protects.
- **The response shapes recovery, so get it right.** Because believing, staying calm, not blaming and then acting shape a child's safety and healing, and the law obliges reporting, the right disclosure response and the routes are what matter most.

Sources: UNESCO (2018) ITGSE Key Concept 4 (violence and keeping safe); child-protection and disclosure-response best practice (believe the child, who very rarely lies about abuse; stay calm rather than show horror; reassure it is not their fault; do not interrogate, leaving detailed questioning to professionals; then act and report); the evidence that around nine in ten child-sexual-abuse cases involve a known, trusted person rather than a stranger; and India's Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act 2012 (any sexual offence against an under-18 is a crime, the child is always the victim, and reporting is obliged), with routes Childline 1098, the police, the POCSO e-Box, cybercrime 1930 for online abuse, and emergency 112. Maximum-care and trauma-informed, never graphic, centring the child as the protected victim, educational and not legal advice. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 69 games now v2; the Parent Layer is complete. Next by order: the Chapter 8 capstone (c8), the grand finale.